

Day 30 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Fundamental Rights I: Equality, Freedom, and Against Exploitation

READING MATERIAL

Covers the first three of the Constitution's six Fundamental Rights categories (Part III, Articles 14-24). Real exam evidence shows TNPSC tests these via correct-Article-range pairing and exact-name traps (e.g. 'Right against Exploitation', not 'Right to Exploitation') more than via plain listing.

Q: What are the six categories of Fundamental Rights in Part III of the Constitution, and which Articles define 'State' and void inconsistent laws?

A: Right to Equality, Right to Freedom, Right against Exploitation, Right to Freedom of Religion, Cultural and Educational Rights, and Right to Constitutional Remedies. Article 12 defines 'State' (for FR purposes); Article 13 declares any law inconsistent with Fundamental Rights void.

Q: Real exam: What Article range covers the Right to Equality, and what does each Article in it cover?

A: Articles 14-18 (confirmed correct in a real exam's correct-pair question). Article 14: equality before law and equal protection of laws. Article 15: prohibition of discrimination on grounds of religion, race, caste, sex, or place of birth. Article 16: equality of opportunity in public employment. Article 17: abolition of untouchability. Article 18: abolition of titles (except military/academic distinctions).

Q: Real exam: Bharat Ratna and Padma awards were instituted under which Article, and why is this notable given that Article's general rule?

A: Article 18 — notable because Article 18 generally ABOLISHES titles, yet the Supreme Court (in the Balaji Raghavan case, 1995) held that Bharat Ratna and Padma awards are NOT 'titles' within the meaning of Article 18 and are therefore constitutionally permissible, since they recognise merit rather than conferring a hereditary/feudal-style title.

Q: What are the 'six freedoms' guaranteed under Article 19, and what happened to the original seventh freedom?

A: Freedom of: (1) speech and expression, (2) assembly, (3) association, (4) movement, (5) residence and settlement, (6) profession/occupation/trade/business — all subject to 'reasonable restrictions.' The ORIGINAL seventh freedom (Right to Property) was removed from Article 19 by the 44th Constitutional Amendment, 1978, and is now only an ordinary legal right under Article 300A, not a Fundamental Right.

Q: What does Article 21 protect, and how did the Maneka Gandhi case (1978) transform its interpretation?

A: Article 21: 'No person shall be deprived of his life or personal liberty except according to procedure established by law.' The Maneka Gandhi v. Union of India case (1978) held that this 'procedure established by law' must itself be just, fair, and reasonable (not arbitrary) — and that Articles 14, 19, and 21 are mutually interlinked, vastly expanding Article 21's scope (it has since been read to include rights like privacy, a clean environment, etc.).

Q: What does Article 21A guarantee, and when was it added?

A: The Right to free and compulsory Education for all children aged 6 to 14 years — added by the 86th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2002, and operationalised via the Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education (RTE) Act, 2009.

Q: What protections does Article 22 provide to arrested persons?

A: A person arrested must be informed of the grounds of arrest, and has the right to consult and be defended by a legal practitioner of their choice; they must be produced before a magistrate within 24 hours (excluding travel time) — with separate, distinct safeguards for preventive detention.

Q: Real exam: What is the EXACT name of the third Fundamental Right category, and what is the common naming trap?

A: 'Right AGAINST Exploitation' — NOT 'Right TO Exploitation.' A real exam question tested exactly this naming trap, asking which Fundamental Right was 'wrongly listed,' with 'Right to Exploitation' as the deliberately wrong-named option.

Q: Real exam: What Article range covers the Right against Exploitation, and what does it prohibit?

A: Articles 23-24 (confirmed correct in the same real exam's correct-pair question). Article 23: prohibits human trafficking and forced labour ('begar'). Article 24: prohibits employment of children below 14 years of age in factories, mines, or other hazardous jobs.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Which Article of the Constitution declares that any law inconsistent with Fundamental Rights shall be void?

A. Article 12

B. Article 13 ✓

C. Article 14

D. Article 32

Explanation: Article 13. [medium, authored]

2. The Right to Equality is covered under which range of Articles?

A. Articles 12-13

B. Articles 14-18 ✓

C. Articles 19-22

D. Articles 23-24

Explanation: Articles 14-18. [medium, question-bank-2026]

3. Article 17 of the Constitution provides for:

A. Equality before law

B. Abolition of untouchability ✓

C. Abolition of titles

D. Equality of opportunity in employment

Explanation: Abolition of untouchability. [easy, authored]

4. Bharat Ratna and Padma awards were instituted under which Article, despite that Article generally abolishing titles?

A. Article 14

B. Article 18 ✓

C. Article 25

D. Article 32

Explanation: Article 18 — the Supreme Court held these awards are not 'titles' under Article 18. [hard, question-bank-2017]

5. Which of the following is NOT one of the six freedoms guaranteed under Article 19?

A. Freedom of speech and expression

B. Freedom to acquire, hold, and dispose of property ✓

C. Freedom of movement

D. Freedom of assembly

Explanation: Right to Property was removed from Article 19 by the 44th Amendment, 1978 — it is no longer a Fundamental Right. [hard, authored]

6. The landmark case that held the 'procedure established by law' under Article 21 must be just, fair, and reasonable was:

A. Kesavananda Bharati case

B. Maneka Gandhi case ✓

C. S.R. Bommai case

D. Minerva Mills case

Explanation: Maneka Gandhi v. Union of India, 1978. [hard, web-research]

7. Article 21A, guaranteeing free and compulsory education for children aged 6-14, was added by which Amendment?

A. 42nd Amendment, 1976

B. 44th Amendment, 1978

C. 73rd Amendment, 1992

D. 86th Amendment, 2002 ✓

Explanation: 86th Amendment, 2002. [medium, web-research]

8. Which one of the following Fundamental Rights has been **WRONGLY** listed?

A. Right to Equality

B. Right to Constitutional Remedies

C. Right to Exploitation ✓

D. Right to Freedom

Explanation: It is 'Right AGAINST Exploitation', not 'Right to Exploitation'. [medium, question-bank-2022]

9. The Right against Exploitation is covered under which Articles, and what does Article 24 specifically prohibit?

A. Articles 19-22; prohibits forced labour

B. Articles 23-24; prohibits child labour in hazardous jobs below age 14 ✓

C. Articles 25-28; prohibits human trafficking

D. Articles 29-30; prohibits forced labour

Explanation: Articles 23-24; Article 24 prohibits child labour in hazardous jobs below age 14. [medium, question-bank-2026]

10. Article 22 of the Constitution provides:

A. Equality of opportunity in public employment

B. Protection against arrest and detention in certain cases ✓

C. Abolition of titles

D. Right to Education

Explanation: Protection against arrest and detention. [medium, authored]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Visual Reasoning

READING MATERIAL

Visual Reasoning is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills, testing image-based logic rather than text/number puzzles — mirror images, water images, and embedded figures are the standard formats. Note: TNPSC's own answer key has at least one acknowledged disputed mirror-image question, a useful reminder that on visual questions specifically, double-check your own reasoning rather than assuming the 'obvious' answer is automatically right.

Q: What is the rule for a MIRROR image, and what stays the same vs. flips?

A: A mirror image flips LEFT and RIGHT (the right side of the object appears on the left, and vice versa), while TOP and BOTTOM stay the same. Imagine holding the figure up to a vertical mirror.

Q: What is the rule for a WATER image, and how is it different from a mirror image?

A: A water image flips TOP and BOTTOM (it appears upside-down, as if reflected in still water below the object), while LEFT and RIGHT stay the same. This is the opposite axis of flipping compared to a mirror image.

Q: What is the best strategy for solving mirror/water image questions quickly?

A: Focus on the most unique or asymmetric part of the figure first (not the symmetric parts, which look the same either way) — mentally flip just that distinctive part along the correct axis (vertical line for mirror, horizontal line for water), and use it to eliminate options before checking the rest.

Q: What is an 'embedded figure' question, and what does it test?

A: A question where a simple shape is hidden within a more complex, cluttered figure, and you must identify which of the answer-choice shapes appears embedded within it. Tests visual scanning and pattern-matching rather than flipping/rotation.

Q: Real exam (flagged as disputed by TNPSC itself): A figure is shown, and you must choose its correct mirror image from 4 options.

What's the most reliable way to verify your choice, given that even the official answer key has had disputed cases here?

A: Don't just eyeball it — explicitly trace which side each distinctive feature should land on after a left-right flip, point by point, rather than relying on a quick visual impression. Given that TNPSC's own committee has had to review at least one mirror-image answer, treat your worked-through reasoning as more trustworthy than a snap visual judgment, and double-check rather than rushing.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. In a MIRROR image of a figure, which pair of sides swap?

- A. Top and bottom
- B. Left and right ✓**
- C. Diagonal corners only
- D. Nothing swaps

Explanation: Left and right swap; top and bottom stay the same. [easy, web-research]

2. In a WATER image of a figure, which pair of sides swap?

- A. Top and bottom ✓**
- B. Left and right
- C. Both pairs swap
- D. Neither swaps

Explanation: Top and bottom swap; left and right stay the same. [easy, web-research]

3. The letter 'b' would appear as which letter in its mirror image (left-right flip)?

- A. b
- B. d ✓**
- C. p
- D. q

Explanation: 'b' has its stem on the left with the bowl attached at bottom-right. Flipping left-right moves the stem to the right with the bowl at bottom-left — that's the letter 'd'. [medium, authored]

4. The letter 'b' would appear as which letter in its water image (top-bottom flip)?

- A. b
- B. d

C. p ✓

D. q

Explanation: Flipping 'b' top-to-bottom keeps the stem on the left but moves the bowl from bottom-right to top-right — that's the letter 'p'. (Mirror and water images of the same letter generally differ — here mirror gives 'd', water gives 'p'.) [hard, authored]

5. An 'embedded figure' question primarily tests:

A. Arithmetic ability

B. Visual scanning and pattern-matching within a cluttered figure ✓

C. Vocabulary

D. Memory of a list

Explanation: Visual scanning/pattern-matching to find a hidden shape within a complex figure. [medium, web-research]

Part C – General English: Prose: "Empowered Women Navigating the World"

READING MATERIAL

A real, recent (2017-18) non-fiction account of 'Navika Sagar Parikrama' — the Indian Navy's first all-women crew to circumnavigate the globe non-stop, aboard the indigenously-built sailboat INSV Tarini, showcasing women's empowerment and the 'Make in India' initiative.

Q: What does INSV stand for, what kind of vessel is INSV Tarini, and after whom is it named?

A: INSV = Indian Naval Ship Vessel. INSV Tarini is a 55-foot sailboat. It is named after Tara-Tarini, regarded as the patron deity for sailors.

Q: How many crew members undertook the voyage, how long did the voyage last, and what renewable energy source did the vessel use?

A: Six all-women crew members. The voyage lasted 254 days. The vessel used wind energy (it is a sailboat).

Q: Where and how long were the crew trained, and who mentored them?

A: They trained in Mumbai and Kochi, over a period of 3 years. They were mentored by Commander Dilip Donde (himself the first Indian to complete a solo non-stop circumnavigation).

Q: What was the name of the overall project/mission, and what national initiative did it aim to showcase?

A: The mission was called 'Navika Sagar Parikrama'. It aimed to showcase women's empowerment and the indigenous 'Make in India' initiative (since INSV Tarini was built in India).

Q: What quality of the skipper was credited with the expedition's success, and what value did one crew member (Payal Gupta) particularly highlight?

A: Honesty was credited as the skipper's key quality for successful leadership. Payal Gupta spoke about the importance of teamwork during the voyage.

Q: What festival did the crew celebrate while at sea, illustrating their resilience and team spirit far from home?

A: Diwali.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. INSV stands for:

- A. Indian National Ship Vessel
- B. Indian Naval Ship Vessel ✓**
- C. Indian Navy Service Vehicle
- D. Indian Nautical Sail Vessel

Explanation: Indian Naval Ship Vessel. [easy, web-research]

2. INSV Tarini is named after Tara-Tarini, who is regarded as the:

- A. Goddess of wisdom
- B. Patron deity for sailors ✓**
- C. Goddess of wealth
- D. Patron deity of warriors

Explanation: Patron deity for sailors. [medium, web-research]

3. How many members were in the all-women crew of INSV Tarini?

- A. Four
- B. Five
- C. Six ✓**
- D. Seven

Explanation: Six. [medium, web-research]

4. The crew underwent training for this voyage at:

- A. Chennai
- B. Kolkata
- C. Mumbai and Kochi ✓**
- D. Delhi and Pune

Explanation: Mumbai and Kochi. [medium, web-research]

5. The crew's training for the voyage lasted approximately:

- A. 6 months
- B. 1 year
- C. 2 years
- D. 3 years ✓**

Explanation: 3 years. [medium, web-research]

6. The crew was mentored by:

- A. Captain Rakesh
- B. Lt. Sinha
- C. Commander Dilip Donde ✓**
- D. Admiral Mehta

Explanation: Commander Dilip Donde. [medium, web-research]

7. The Indian Navy's all-women circumnavigation voyage aboard INSV Tarini lasted how many days?

- A. 180
- B. 200
- C. 254 ✓**
- D. 300

Explanation: 254 days. [easy, web-research]

8. What kind of vessel is INSV Tarini, and what renewable energy powers it?

- A. A cargo ship powered by solar energy
- B. A submarine powered by hydro energy
- C. A 55-foot sailboat powered by wind energy ✓**
- D. An oil tanker powered by biomass

Explanation: A 55-foot sailboat, powered by wind. [medium, web-research]

9. Which quality of the skipper is credited with the expedition's success?

- A. Bravery
- B. Strength
- C. Honesty ✓**
- D. Discipline

Explanation: Honesty. [medium, web-research]

10. The mission name for this all-women circumnavigation voyage was:

- A. Sagar Mitra
- B. Navika Sagar Parikrama ✓**
- C. Samudra Setu
- D. Nau Sena Abhiyan

Explanation: Navika Sagar Parikrama. [medium, web-research]